FLORIDA COURTS
E-FILING AUTHORITY

MEETING MINUTES

Florida Courts E-Filing Authority Board of Directors
July 27, 2026
3:00 p.m., ET

The Florida Courts E-Filing Authority Board of Directors (Board) met on July 27, 2026.

☑ **The Hon. Tara S. Green, Chair** (Clerk of Court, Clay County)
☑ **The Hon. Todd Newton, Vice Chair | District III** (Clerk of Court, Gilchrist County)
☑ **The Hon. Laura E. Roth, Esq. | District IV** (Clerk of Court, Volusia County)
☑ **The Hon. John Tomasino** (Clerk of the Court, Florida Supreme Court)
☑ **The Hon. Brad E. Embry | District I** (Clerk of Court, Okaloosa County)
☑ **The Hon. Steve Land | District II** (Clerk of Court, Lafayette County)
☑ **The Hon. Juan Fernandez-Barquin, Esq. | District VII** (Clerk of Court, Miami-Dade County)
☑ **The Hon. Rachel M. Sadoff | District V** (Clerk of Court, Brevard County)
☑ **The Hon. Karen E. Rushing| District VI** (Clerk of Court, Sarasota County)

☑ Present ☐ Not Present

I. Introduction and Roll Call

The Honorable Tara S. Green, Chair, called the meeting to order at 3:02 p.m., ET, welcoming everyone to the Florida Courts E-Filing Authority Board of Directors. Beth Allman, Portal Program Administrator, called the roll, and a quorum was present.

II. Public Comment-Agenda Items Only

There were no public comments related to agenda items.

III. Adoption of the Agenda

MOTION: The Honorable Todd Newton made a motion to adopt the agenda. The Honorable Steve Land seconded the motion, and the motion passed unanimously.

IV. Reading and Approval of Minutes

The Honorable Laura E. Roth, Esq., Secretary/Treasurer, explained the June 22, 2026, minutes were in the meeting materials. She asked if there were any additions or corrections. Chair Green requested her title and county to be corrected. The minutes were accepted with Chair Green's correction to the minutes.

V. Treasurer's Report

Monthly Financial Report

Secretary/Treasurer Roth presented the May 2026 financial report.

- Assets were $5.19 M
- Liabilities were $2.2 M
- Net income for May was $1.10 M with expense of $1.10 M.
- Net income year to date was $524,000, $413,000 better than the budgeted net income. The outperformance of the budget has been driven by a higher growth rate in filing fee payments.
- The final page of the financial statements displays the Vending Service Fee paid to Civitek for operating the E-Filing Portal.
- As of May 31, Civitek was holding $4.88 M in reserves for future operations.

MOTION: The Honorable John Tomasino made a motion to accept the Treasurer's Report. The Honorable Todd Newton seconded the motion, and the motion passed unanimously.

VI. Progress Reports

E-Portal Progress Report

Mr. Michael Beckley, Portal Program Manager, reviewed the Portal Projects status report noting the following topics:

- Latest Release – 2026.01 Maintenance Release
- Single Session Rewrite Project
- Standard Document Descriptions Project
- 2026.02 November Release
- Status Page

Mr. Beckley stated a new third party vendor, Pro Legal Services, meets all the necessary requirements and asked for Board approval.

MOTION: The Honorable Todd Newton made a motion to accept Pro Legal Services as a certified third party vendor. The Honorable Rachel M. Sadoff seconded the motion, and the motion passed unanimously.

Service Desk Report

Ms. Gia Howell, Portal Service Desk Supervisor, reviewed the highlights of the June 2026 Service Desk Report. For FY 2025-26, she reported nearly 200,000

new accounts were created and a more than 8½% volume increase in E-Filing tickets was noted. Self-reported litigants were the largest number of tickets with a 40% increase from last fiscal year.

VII. Florida Courts Technology Commission (FCTC)

The Honorable Karen E. Rushing reported FCCC is communicating with FCTC about the complexities of creating enhancements to the Portal to allow the associations of various documents to support the Court's case management initiatives. She noted a survey was sent to all Clerks relating to whether or not Clerks are displaying the DIN # in their local case maintenance system and what number they are submitting to CCIS.

Request for Work on Estimate for Document Linking

Ms. Melissa Bennefield, FCCC Chief Operating Officer, explained the FCTC requested the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal (Portal) team develop an estimate associated with potential document-linking functionality within the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal (Portal). The request was the ability for filers to link related documents and for those relationships to be transmitted to the Clerks' case maintenance systems and Court Application Processing Systems to improve case management automation and reporting. Ms. Bennefield stated the team has done some preliminary information gathering but is requesting the Board's approval to create an official work estimate. The Portal team hopes to have the estimate in advance of the August 13–14, 2026, FCTC meeting, where it is expected to continue its discussion of this initiative.

MOTION: The Honorable Karen E. Rushing made a motion to authorize the Portal team to develop a work estimate for the document linking effort in the Portal as suggested by FCTC. The Honorable Steve Land seconded the motion, and the motion passed unanimously.

VIII. Old Business

Value Added Service – Status Update

The Value Added Service project is now being called Case Access and is on schedule. Quality assurance testing should be completed at the end of August with user acceptance testing following. The production launch is scheduled for early October. The project team is working with a marketing firm to finalize project logos and marketing material.

The Honorable John Tomasino asked if the Board would see the invoices for the work performed at the next Authority meeting. Ms. Bennefield explained invoices would not be compiled until October when work is complete.

Trademark Proposal Review

Ms. Bennefield explained Civitek has been reviewing and evaluating the status of all trademarks related to their products and services identifying any which can benefit with additional brand recognition. Staff included assets for the E-Filing Authority in this evaluation. During the June Board meeting, the Board requested staff include trademarks for the Authority and Portal included in that plan. Greenberg Traurig is researching the trademark registration process and providing a cost estimate and next steps for the names Florida Courts E-Filing Authority, Florida Courts E-Filing Portal, and Case Access. Staff is finalizing the proposal for approval at the September Board meeting.

IX. New Business

There was no new business to discuss.

X. Report on FCTC/RGPJAC Joint Work Group and Other Rules

Mr. Tom Hall, Esq. stated an FCTC committee continues to work on the vexatious litigant issue related to statute changes. It is developing a standard form to capture needed items in a court order when judges declare someone a vexatious litigant. Another subcommittee is recommending an amendment to a Florida Bar rule change relating to terms of service for the Portal allowing only three email addresses be used, no matter how many cases are filed. Mr. Hall noted the issue relating to Rule 2.345, Judicial Signatures, currently requiring Clerks to validate signatures on court documents as being valid electronic signatures of the judges, is ongoing.

XI. Public Comment

Mr. Todd Curry explained he was having issues filing from Canada on behalf of an elderly friend and had submitted a ticket to the Help Desk for assistance but had not received resolution. He stated he was being blocked because his Canadian IP address was detected as being different. He requested to be “unblocked” so he could file a caveat into his friend’s case. He asked that Ms.Gia Howell and Mr. Michael Beckley look into the issue. Chair Green stated his comments will be part of the record.

XII. Adjourn

Chair Green stated the next Board meeting will be scheduled in mid to late September. With no further business, the meeting was adjourned at 3:46 p.m., ET.